



**CYBERSECURITY
& INFRASTRUCTURE
SECURITY AGENCY**



Houses of Worship Security Self-Assessment Results for Turner Theological Seminary, 702 M.L.K. Jr Dr SW South, Atlanta, GA 30314

On 2025-11-17, personnel representing the Turner Theological Seminary, 702 M.L.K. Jr Dr SW South, Atlanta, GA 30314 conducted a security self-assessment using the Houses of Worship Security Self-Assessment developed by the U.S. Department of Homeland Security (DHS) Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA).

This report summarizes the results of that process, listing vulnerabilities (i.e., areas where the facility could improve) and options for consideration (i.e., strategies for enhancing security) that were identified using the guided self-assessment tool. These options outline specific actions that facility personnel can prioritize based on their existing security practices and available resources.

Completion of this self-assessment is one step in a broader process of improving physical security at Turner Theological Seminary, 702 M.L.K. Jr Dr SW South, Atlanta, GA 30314. Ongoing efforts to improve security and manage risk will support the organization's mission to provide a safe environment for its congregants.

Results from Self-Assessment

The table below summarizes the results of the self-assessment completed by Turner Theological Seminary, 702 M.L.K. Jr Dr SW South, Atlanta, GA 30314. The information includes the following content:

- Section: six sections addressing core elements of physical security at houses of worship (i.e., security and emergency management; security force; perimeter security and delineation; parking and barriers; access control and entry control; and closed-circuit video and video surveillance systems)
- Vulnerability: potential security concern that leaves a house of worship susceptible to different types of threats

- Option for Consideration: potential actions that houses of worship can take to address identified vulnerabilities

Category	Vulnerability	Option for Consideration
Security / Emergency Management	The house of worship has a security manager or committee. Security management activities are regularly scheduled and coordinated with other committees, departments, and groups, and staffing levels fully support the facility's security mission.	Regularly assess the facility's security management program. Conduct security surveys, risk assessments, and threat assessments of the facility and neighboring areas. Implement best practices based on collaborative relationships and new or updated resources.
Security / Emergency Management	The house of worship has a written security and emergency operations plan(s). The security plan or portion of the plan addresses some, but not all, of the following areas: identification of threats; security force; access control; monitoring and surveillance; suspicious activity recognition and reporting; financial and cybersecurity; hiring procedures and background checks; daycare, school, and youth security (where applicable); special event and offsite excursion safety and security; and opening, locking, and closing procedures for the facility. The emergency operations plan or portion of the plan addresses some, but not all, of the following areas: threat and hazard analysis; goals and objectives; procedures for medical emergencies, bomb threats, and active shooter incidents; communication, crisis management, and media procedures; evacuation, shelter-in-place, lockout, and lockdown procedures; reunification of children and parents or guardians; and recovery and resumption of operations. The plan(s) addresses maintaining point-of-contact lists, training and exercises, and plan maintenance (e.g., review and revision).	Update the plan(s) to address all of the areas listed above. If the security and emergency operations plans are combined, explore the option of separating security topics from emergency operations topics into two separate plans.

Category	Vulnerability	Option for Consideration
Security / Emergency Management	The house of worship provides some information or training to some employees and volunteers, but not to everyone involved with implementing the plan(s). The house of worship may provide training less often than annually.	At least once a year, hold a meeting to educate all involved parties on the plan. Show involved parties where evacuation sites, reunification areas, media areas, and triage areas will be located. Provide training on the skills necessary for individuals to fulfill their roles. Persons will be assigned specific roles in the plan that will require special skills, such as first aid and the provision of personal assistance services for children, the elderly, individuals with disabilities, and others with access and functional needs.
Security / Emergency Management	The house of worship provides some training to congregants at least once a year. Training may be limited to the appropriate emergency response actions for primary locations only (e.g., main gathering area, fellowship hall, classrooms).	Evaluate the need to provide more frequent training to congregants. Evaluate the completeness of training and provide additional information as necessary. Train congregants on appropriate emergency response actions regardless of their location in the house of worship. Ensure congregants are trained to cooperate and not to interfere with first responders.
Security / Emergency Management	The house of worship has provided the security and emergency operations plan(s) to first responders but has not solicited or implemented their input on the plan. The house of worship has not shared critical information about the building or facilities (e.g., floor plans, location of critical assets or areas, and notification and contact lists). Emergency responders have not toured the house of worship in order to familiarize themselves with the layout of the building and grounds.	Review the security and emergency operations plan(s) with first responders, and make changes as necessary. Share critical building and facilities information with first responders. Invite law enforcement, fire response, and emergency medical services personnel who have a role in the plan to tour the house of worship.
Security / Emergency Management	The house of worship exercises the plan(s) at least once annually. Exercises are tabletop or drills and involve relevant facility personnel. They do not include community partners (e.g., first responders, local emergency management staff).	Invite community partners to participate in exercises that test the plan(s).

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Security / Emergency Management	The facility has comprehensive lockdown, lockout, and shelter-in-place procedures. Lockdown, lockout, and shelter-in-place procedures and locations have been communicated to congregants, but key information is not posted throughout the building.	Post key information (e.g., lockout procedures, lockdown and shelter-in-place locations) throughout the facility to provide congregants with easy access to this information.
Security / Emergency Management	The house of worship monitors external sources for important emergency information and has a public address system for onsite emergency communications but lacks ways to communicate warnings to individuals who need other accommodations such as visual signals. The house of worship does not periodically test the system.	Explore options to communicate warnings more effectively beyond only audible alerts, such as strobe lights. Test the emergency mass communication system periodically to ensure its functionality and so employees, volunteers, and congregants are familiar with its use.
Security / Emergency Management	The house of worship has crisis communications plans and procedures that address emergency contacts, chain of command, and distribution of mass notifications, but they may lack some level of detail. A spokesperson for the congregation may not have been designated or may have been designated without relevant training and/or resources.	Evaluate crisis communications plans and procedures for completeness. Include procedures for coordinating with local government, crisis communications, and external affairs officials (e.g., public information officers). Ensure plans address how affected congregants will be supported if they prefer not to engage with the media. This may include strategies for keeping the media separate from congregants while the emergency is ongoing and supporting congregants who may experience unwanted media attention at their homes. Designate a spokesperson for the congregation to gather the facts and issue statements. Provide the spokesperson with relevant training and/or resources. Stipulate that other congregants refrain from speaking to the media.
Security / Emergency Management	The house of worship monitors open-source intelligence information related to threats against houses of worship, but has not joined any trusted communities of peers and partners exchanging issues, ideas, intelligence,	Request access to a vetted, private information-sharing network such as FB-ISAQ. Contact the local police department regarding access to crime report information.

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	and other information across private networks.	
Security / Emergency Management	Facility personnel are connected with a security or emergency preparedness working group. They regularly attend meetings and receive information.	Seek out more ways for facility personnel to benefit from participating in the security or emergency preparedness working group, for example, by getting involving in special events or activities or by taking leadership positions in the group.
Security / Emergency Management	The house of worship procures background checks on all employees and volunteers. However, the type of background checks conducted may provide minimal information, creating a false sense of security.	Procure thorough background checks that include criminal history and prior employment. Require individuals who handle money to consent to a credit and background check. Run a license check on individuals who drive vehicles.
Security / Emergency Management	The house of worship provides information about specific security incidents as well as security awareness information to employees and volunteers. However, security awareness information is limited in scope and availability (e.g., provided occasionally).	Provide more detailed and comprehensive security awareness information. Disseminate information regularly.
Security / Emergency Management	The facility has bomb threat and suspicious item procedures, but some information may be lacking. The facility may not communicate these procedures to employees and volunteers. Congregants are aware that if they encounter a suspicious item, they should leave it alone and notify someone in authority.	Review the existing bomb threat and suspicious item procedures, and incorporate additional information as needed. Share the updated procedures with employees and volunteers.
Security / Emergency Management	Cash storage is adequately secured or money is deposited immediately. The house of worship has established cash-handling policies and procedures and financial safety protocols. A two-party system is in place to ensure that no one person has sole access to contributions and other collections. Financial records are detailed and accurate. However, not all individuals with cash access have undergone a background check that includes a credit check.	Screen individuals with access to contributions and other collections with a thorough background check that includes a credit check.

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Security Force	A security team or volunteer security force exists but has minimal presence and conducts periodic patrols. A local police officer may be present or conduct an onsite visit once during main gathering times to assist in security response, entry and traffic control, and administering security policy.	Establish agreements or contracts to employ a security force with the specific purpose of facility security. Contact local law enforcement and coordinate onsite visits with an on-duty officer during regular gathering times.
Security Force	The house of worship has some posters or security awareness training for personnel at initial employment. The training may include refresher training on emergency response activities at irregular intervals, but no other follow-up takes place throughout the year.	Use the DHS Active Shooter Preparedness website as needed to enhance training. In addition to initial employment and once per year, conduct follow-up training at least one other time throughout the year. Develop or contract a formal training program for those responsible for security such as emergency response Incident Command System/National Incident Management System. Provide continuation and in-service training for employees and volunteers to maintain and enhance job proficiency. Document training and retain training records.
Security Force	A trained security force/team or individual occasionally inspects the house of worship according to an established security checklist.	Conduct daily inspection of sensitive areas especially before people gather. Ensure doors are not propped open, and windows, loading areas, and exterior doors are secured. Report suspicious activity, weapons, and drugs to the security force and law enforcement as needed.
Security Force	The house of worship has panic alarms in the administrative office but no other similar equipment.	Expand the use of panic alarms to include employees and volunteers and isolated or sensitive locations at the house of worship. This may include childcare areas, administrative offices, and common areas.
Security Force	Personnel are assigned to monitor for threats during times of critical vulnerability. However, they have received little to no training for this position and have no special equipment.	Provide training to monitoring personnel. Relevant topics may include intruder response, reverse evacuation, and how to assist in the arrival of public safety vehicles. Provide personnel with a radio to communicate with

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		building/office staff or the security force/team, and ensure they have access to a phone for calling 9-1-1. Areas to be monitored should include sanctuary and building entrances, as well as parking areas.
Security Force	The security force has some dedicated posts and some basic or spoken instructions for the security duties at each post/patrol.	If not already written, write basic procedures and responsibilities of each area/post/patrol. Topics for these post orders should include description of post/area/patrol, contact information, procedures for access control, equipment control, emergency procedures, and other duties and procedures as necessary. Incorporate the post orders into the security plan that communicates not only specific procedures, but also a code of ethics, standards of conduct and security policies for the organization.
Security Force	Ushers, greeters, and volunteers have received training in security awareness and threat detection, and regular or periodic meetings take place to inform personnel of recent security and/or threat information.	Create an ongoing training program for ushers, greeters, and volunteers to continue to communicate indicators of suspicious behavior, ongoing security concerns and other security incidents relevant to the community. Conduct some basic exercises to test the process.
Security Force	Personnel can informally report security concerns to administrative staff or other personnel, but no formal mechanism (e.g., special radio, phone number or email address) exists to report security concerns.	Provide a formal means of reporting non-immediate and immediate security concerns. For immediate concerns, the process may include distributing a radio to contact the security team or cell phone number of someone who can respond. Provide de-escalation training for those responders. For non-immediate security concerns, the facility may distribute and post a designated security phone number or email account that is checked regularly. Develop a program for handling at-risk individuals.
Perimeter Security / Delineation	The house of worship does not have a full perimeter fence or wall, but it does have a well-defined perimeter and/or	Install additional fencing to enclose the facility to the maximum extent possible and/or employ CPTED principles

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	some elements of fencing that identify legal boundaries and may funnel foot and vehicle traffic to specific areas. It may enclose a part of the grounds such as an athletic field or other assets.	and/or barriers (e.g., bollards, decorative flower pots, high curbs, shallow ditches) to provide enhanced penetration delay. If fences are installed in places where people gather, ensure proper egress exists from the area in the case of an emergency.
Perimeter Security / Delineation	The house of worship has little or no natural surveillance from the building to the outer perimeter. Multiple layers of vegetation block the view from the facility to the perimeter. Avenues of approach to the facility are not fully visible.	Use an inside-outward approach and view the property from the building outward. Identify overgrown vegetation, large objects such as statues and landscaping devices, and other objects that block the ability to identify people approaching the facility. Create a plan to reduce the amount of vegetation and objects that obstruct the view of critical areas and assets such as vehicle approaches, pedestrian avenues of approach, or public spaces. The plan may take a phased approach to reduce obstructions as time and budget permit. Observe and document traffic flows in the facility. Identify areas where congregants must pass through a controlled or restricted zone to reach a public or common space. Congregants who do not have special access to controlled zones should be able to enter the facility and use all public and common spaces without crossing into controlled or restricted zones. If possible, reroute traffic or ensure controlled or restricted zones are locked. Use signage to identify areas where congregants should not go.
Perimeter Security / Delineation	Public and private spaces are mixed throughout the facility. In some cases, congregants and visitors must use hallways or offices dedicated to internal staff in order to reach other public areas such as restrooms or common areas.	
Perimeter Security / Delineation	The purpose of the fence/wall is more decorative or to define the perimeter, but it does not deter or delay an intruder.	If improvements to the fence are not possible, employ CPTED principles.
Perimeter Security / Delineation	Gates exist in some areas but not others. Gates may be a single swing arm or moveable chains that an intruder could easily defeat.	Install gates at identified pedestrian/vehicle gaps along the perimeter. Ensure that all gates have at least equivalent properties to the rest of the fence.

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Perimeter Security / Delineation	The perimeter is not illuminated at all, or Illumination appears to be uneven and dissimilar in type causing glare and shadows with inconsistent coverage in most areas, creating dark areas and shadows.	Install lighting on the perimeter. Ensure the lighting is even and overlapping to avoid shadows, dark areas and glare. Ensure lighting is compatible with existing or planned closed-circuit video (CCV) systems.
Parking & Barriers	The facility conducts random visual screening of vehicles but does not conduct vehicle searches. Parking areas may have some security camera coverage, but gaps in coverage exist.	Provide full camera coverage and adequate lighting for videotaping activity in the parking lots, and/or conduct periodic patrols around the parking area and visually screen for potentially dangerous items. Post signage identifying that parking areas are monitored.
Parking & Barriers	The facility does not have a policy to address extended-stay vehicles parked onsite. A vehicle may remain parked on the property for an indefinite period of time without being reported.	Develop policies to address extended-stay vehicles. Install signs in the parking area to deter this practice.
Parking & Barriers	Some parking is monitored, but not by security personnel. Signs, pavement markings, and/or orange cones are used to direct traffic, but some education and enforcement is also needed.	Explore ways to employ security personnel to monitor most parking areas. Identify areas that allow vehicle placement within 30-50 feet of the facility, and evaluate options to reduce the facility's exposure to nearby vehicle placement.
Parking & Barriers	The facility has mitigated one or more high-speed avenue(s) of approach using effective and correctly placed bollards, barriers, or natural materials. Mitigation may include one or many types and combinations of bollards, barriers, or natural materials as long as they are effective at mitigating any and all high-speed avenue(s) of approach.	Prioritize unmitigated high-speed avenues of approach, and begin efforts to mitigate these vulnerabilities, beginning with the most critical.
Parking & Barriers	The facility has an unmitigated standoff distance of less than 50 feet. Some areas may have a standoff distance of 20-30 feet or more, but the configuration has gaps.	Allow only employee and volunteer parking near the building, and restrict visitor or general public parking to 20-50 or more feet away. Restrict parking between individual buildings. At small standoff distances, even a few feet make a large difference.
Parking & Barriers	Illumination appears to be similar and consistent in type; however light	Develop a plan to improve lighting in parking areas. Improvements can

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Access Control / Entry Control	pattern coverage does not overlap causing shadows or dark areas.	include increasing the type and number of luminaires and/or upgrading to more modern bulb types such as LED. Ensure pathways from entrances to parking areas are well-illuminated.
	No screening takes place at the house of worship. Anything can be brought into the sanctuary, administrative areas or fellowship halls at any time without question.	Limit or prohibit bags, packages, and backpacks in administrative areas or fellowship halls unless accompanied by known persons or escorts. Train ushers and administrative personnel on unusual activity and unusual packages. If possible, post signs banning weapons. Train personnel to not accept unscheduled deliveries or packages from unknown delivery services. Establish, publish, post, and distribute procedures for items brought to fellowship halls, administrative areas, and sanctuaries. This may include not allowing packages or items dropped off or unattended without notification or someone of authority in attendance. Evaluate the feasibility of magnetometer screening throughout the facility or on primary worship service days. Establish a holding area for deliveries.
Access Control / Entry Control	Doors and windows to the house of worship are locked when not occupied. The doors are unlocked for a period of time before and after primary worship services, but they are attended during services so that anyone entering the building after the start time will be recognized by ushers. Administrative areas are locked when not occupied and also when only one or two people are onsite. A cash room is always locked, even when occupied, and a two-person rule is in place. A fellowship hall/meeting room is locked when not in use and are locked when practical during times of use.	Maintain door and window locks. Continue to train ushers or the security team on access control.

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Access Control / Entry Control	Exterior doors have access card control. Interior doors may have a mix of locksets that include keyed cylinder.	Review all locksets and establish a plan to upgrade from keyed cylinder. Evaluate hinges windows and door frames for other weaknesses.
Access Control / Entry Control	Keys are maintained in a locked container. Lost keys are reported and when necessary, and locks are replaced. Duplicates are serial-numbered, recorded, and tracked. A card access control system exists. At least two trusted members of the facility maintain the card access database. Changes to the database occur monthly allowing some cards to possibly be active when in fact the card access should have been removed.	Minimize the use of keys, and maintain the key control program. Continue to improve the card access system. Ensure database changes are immediate.
Access Control / Entry Control	Exterior windows are tempered glass and can be opened. The windows are large enough and at a height that an adult could climb through them when open. Doors are mostly glass or metal-framed glass.	Publish and distribute guidance to avoid areas with glass features during an attack. Determine if it is practical to use wood or steel doors with smaller areas of glass. Replacing windows with smaller, nonoperational windows is an expensive option and may not be possible. If that is the case, close and lock windows at all times. If the house of worship requires windows to be open for ventilation, ensure everyone knows how to close and lock a window in an emergency. Other possibilities include installing heavy window coverings that can be lowered or slide on tracks and that can be positioned quickly or even remotely. This may provide some concealment from an attacker.
Access Control / Entry Control	The house of worship has no IDS.	Install an alarm system. This may be an internal system tied to a CCV system or a contract service that monitors, reports, and dispatches police as needed.
Access Control / Entry Control	The facility's interior consists of rows with reasonable breaks. Some sections may be pews or chairs affixed to the floor while other sections can be easily and quickly moved. Some have shorter	Avoid using chairs that hook together or are affixed to the floor, if possible. Coordinate with local code management and fire departments for guidance.

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	rows of collapsible chairs. (Reasonable is defined as less than 12 people in a row.)	
Access Control / Entry Control	The house of worship has a large main entrance that is occasionally crowded or obstructed. Numerous other exits throughout the main area of the facility may be crowded or overwhelmed during an emergency evacuation.	Coordinate with building and fire code enforcement personnel and determine if additional exits should be added or existing exits modified to improve the exit process.
Closed-circuit Video/Video Surveillance Systems	Cameras cover most of the house of worship, including entrances and sensitive areas.	Conduct a camera system survey to identify any areas where coverage may still be lacking.
Closed-circuit Video/Video Surveillance Systems	The camera system typically uses a single fixed camera to provide coverage for each entrance.	Conduct a camera system survey to identify areas where cameras are ineffective. Based on the results of the survey, perform system updates.
Closed-circuit Video/Video Surveillance Systems	Trained staff members monitor the CCV/VSS and do not have additional duties that could distract them from monitoring the system. However, they must follow too many screens at once (typically more than eight). They do not receive regular breaks, which impacts their ability to monitor multiple camera feeds effectively.	Explore options to maximize the effectiveness of monitoring and observation, such as frequently rotating shifts for staff and limiting the number of cameras each staff member monitors.
Closed-circuit Video/Video Surveillance Systems	Personnel review recorded information only after an incident. The storage capability is limited to a week or less, so many events are not available after the fact.	Increase the camera system's storage capacity, preferably to a month.
Closed-circuit Video/Video Surveillance Systems	The CCV/VSS is in good condition, but some cameras are inoperable, even in key locations. Maintenance or repair is contracted work. The system has backup power.	Repair or replace any inoperable cameras. Ensure continuous updates are applied to the system, and test it routinely.

Observations

Security /Emergency Management: This facility is a multipurpose house of worship, seminary training for clergy, and residential dorm facility for students. Although some security policies,

procedures, and technology are now in place under the current president/CEO, upgrades are needed and training drills must be enacted in accordance with the planned schedule.

Security Force: There is a single security officer post in place, which is a 24-hour post; however, the security personnel are not uniformly trained nor are they trained on a regular frequency, although the new policy does account for this in the future.

Perimeter Security /Delineation: The perimeter of the campus in which the facility is located has a fence and guard booth; however, the equipment is in a partial state of disrepair, but the access points are not staffed properly and regularly.

Parking & Barriers: The ingress and egress paths to the parking areas adjacent the building are via winding driveways and neighboring lots. Although there are no speed bumps/humps nor bollards, the natural contour of the path does provide some deterrent to excessive speed via CPTED.

Access Control / Entry Control: This multipurpose facility does use VizPin for access control; however, there are some exterior doors that are in a condition of needing some repair. Interior doors are on lock and key, with some keys having been lost to some dorm rooms.

CCV/VSS: This facility uses Dahua Technology with fixed cameras, cloud recording, and a hard drive backup to monitor the facility. The system should be upgraded to include PTZ cameras and optimal placement.

Next Steps

Develop a Prioritization Plan

If not already established, form an internal team to evaluate and prioritize the options for consideration identified in this report, taking into account the facility's characteristics, budgetary outlook, and relevant local regulations.

Connect with Federal, State, and Local Authorities

Use this report as a starting point for engagement with local law enforcement or state and federal partners who can assist your organization in improving its physical security. CISA has Protective Security Advisors in each state across the country who can provide guidance on available resources, coordination of local assets, and suggestions on implementing the actions identified in this report.

Use to Inform Investment Justifications for Organizational Budgets and Grants

Explore different options that may be available for resourcing actions identified in this report. Houses of worship may be able to address some of the options for consideration identified in this report by applying existing organizational resources. In addition, public and private partners manage grant programs focused on improving facility security. The results of this self-assessment may serve as an input into grant program applications, depending on program focus areas and application requirements.

Reference Materials for Houses of Worship

Security/Emergency Management

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Acronyms and Abbreviations

ADL
 Anti-Defamation League
 CCV
 Closed-circuit Video
 CISA
 Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Agency
 CPG
 Comprehensive Preparedness Guide
 CPTED
 Crime Prevention Through Environmental Design
 DHS
 U.S. Department of Homeland Security
 DOJ
 U.S. Department of Justice
 ED
 U.S. Department of Education
 Federal Bureau of Investigation
 FB-ISA
 Faith-Based Information Sharing & Analysis Organization
 FEMA
 Federal Emergency Management Agency
 HHS
 U.S. Department of Health and Human Services
 HSEEP
 Homeland Security Exercise and Evaluation Program
 ISC
 Interagency Security Committee

NIJ

National Institute of Justice

NSI

Nationwide SAR Initiative

PTZ

Pan-tilt-zoom

SAMHSA

Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration

VSS

Video Surveillance System